

# Credible consensus among strangers

A jury for funding the research commons

Institute of Open Science Practices (IOSP) 2026, Leiden · Wednesday 14 October 2026

Preview handout: the room and mailing-list addresses await deployment.

## Two questions

Did they ship it? Evidence can answer that. How much does it matter? That is a judgment under a policy. A credible consensus is a candidate answer that a community can act on.

## The game in five lines

1. Read one published policy.
2. Score each nominee alone; seal the score.
3. Open the scores together.
4. Inside the band, share the reward by closeness to the centre.
5. Outside the band, forfeit more the farther you land from it.

## What the design is meant to do

Pay for coherence with the room under one public policy. It does not prove that honest scoring wins, or that agreement alone makes a judgment credible.

The centre and band are derived from the same jury. The workshop uses points and equal seats; random draws weighted by stake and appeals belong to the proposed full design.

## The shared question

How much does this nominee's completed and maintained work underpin how research is done, shared and kept, now?

Docket: Inkscape, Linux, PDF, LaTeX, arXiv, NumPy.

## Four objections

| Objection           | Proposed defence                                                                                                      |
|---------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Herdling</b>     | Sealed scores hide other jurors' readings until they can no longer change them.                                       |
| <b>Vote buying</b>  | A proof shown to a buyer can be reported for a bounty, making verification risky.                                     |
| <b>Collusion</b>    | Random draws weighted by stake, forfeits and appeals to larger juries are proposed. No safe threshold is established. |
| <b>Vague policy</b> | Worked anchors and recusal help strangers apply the same question.                                                    |

## Where it fits

Review panels, grant programmes and community funds: a community sets the policy; a jury supplies scores to inform its decisions.

## Try, read, stay in touch

|                            |                                                                                       |                                        |
|----------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------|
| Room<br>address<br>pending |  | Mailing-<br>list<br>address<br>pending |
| The room                   | The working paper                                                                     | Mailing list                           |

Working paper:  
[doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20543760](https://doi.org/10.5281/zenodo.20543760)